

MSP | MSP-20

Issue and Change Management Approach

How programme issues and changes will be controlled

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Issue and Change Management Approach
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Project / Programme	Programme Helios
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Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Programme Board
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
MSP-11	Programme Governance Approach	Decision rights
MSP-04	Target Operating Model	Subject of design change

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines how issues are captured, assessed and resolved at programme level, and how changes to the programme baseline are controlled.
Framework	MSP — Decisions theme; created in Define the Programme
Created when	Define the Programme
Reviewed / updated	At each tranche boundary
Owner	Programme Manager
Approver	Programme Board
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The boundary between project-level and programme-level issues is unambiguous
- Change to the target operating model has a defined design authority route
- Change to the business case has a defined re-approval route
- Timescales for each step are stated and realistic

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1. Scope and definitions

Term	Definition at programme level
Issue	<i>Programme Helios</i>
Change request	<i>Programme Helios</i>
Design change	<i>Programme Helios</i>
Baseline change	<i>Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0</i>
Escalation	<i>To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three</i>

2. Issue management procedure

Capture

Assess

Propose

Decide

Implement and close

3. Change control procedure

Include the route for changes affecting the target operating model, the projects dossier, the programme plan and the business case.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build. Detail is maintained by the Programme Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

4. Categories and routing

Category	Definition	Assessed by	Decided by	Target timescale
Minor	<i>No baseline impact — decided by the Programme Manager within 2 working days</i>	Programme Office	Programme Manager	<i>No baseline impact — decided by the Programme Manager within 2 working days</i>
Significant	<i>The elapsed time from a researcher submitting a job to its first GPU allocation</i>	Design Authority	Programme Board	<i>2 hours</i>
Major	<i>Exceeds tolerance — Programme Board decision at the next monthly meeting</i>	Programme Board	SRO	<i>Exceeds tolerance — Programme Board decision at the next monthly meeting</i>
Strategic	<i>Affects the business case or benefit profile — Portfolio Board decision</i>	SRO	Sponsoring Group	<i>Affects the business case or benefit profile — Portfolio Board decision</i>

5. Escalation from projects

When a project must escalate an issue to the programme, and how the programme responds.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier. Detail is maintained by the Programme Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

6. Impact assessment criteria

Dimension	Assessment required	Assessed by
Target operating model	<i>Level 2 — repeatable</i>	<i>G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead</i>
Benefits	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>

Dimension	Assessment required	Assessed by
Business case	High residual exposure; active mitigation in place	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
Programme plan	Programme Helios	Programme Helios
Dependencies	Level 2 — repeatable	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
Risk profile	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Stakeholders	Level 2 — repeatable	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead

7. Programme issue register

Ref	Raised	Source	Description	Category	Impact	Owner	Decision	Status
ISS-001	31 Mar 2027	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Chilled water return temperature in DXB-1 hall A is running 4°C above design, limiting sustained rack density to 48 kW against the 60 kW design point	Facilities	Hall A capacity capped at 1,536 GPUs until resolved; Tranche 2 milestone M6 at risk	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Deferred to the next Board	Open
ISS-002	26 Feb 2027	Configuration management database	Vendor has confirmed a six-week slip on the second tranche of 1,024 accelerators, from 12 Oct to 23 Nov 2026	Supply chain	Hall B build start moves to Dec 2026; two weeks of float remaining on the critical path	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	Rejected	Open
ISS-003	31 Jan 2027	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Penetration test of the pilot cluster found that the cluster API server was reachable from the corporate management VLAN without mutual TLS	Security	Multi-tenant go-live cannot be approved until closed; finding logged against the assurance plan	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Approved	Open

Ref	Raised	Source	Description	Category	Impact	Owner	Decision	Status
ISS-004	15 Dec 2026	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Two of the six SRE vacancies remain unfilled after three months of recruitment	Resource	On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at hall A handover	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Approved with conditions	Open
ISS-005	30 Nov 2026	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	NCCL all-reduce benchmark on the pilot fabric is achieving 84% efficiency against the 92% target	Technical	Training throughput assumptions in the business case may be optimistic by around 9%	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	Deferred to the next Board	Open
ISS-006	15 Oct 2026	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Integration partner has submitted a change claim of AED 1.84m for additional structural works not identified at tender	Commercial	Contingency drawdown of 12% if accepted in full	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	Rejected	Open
ISS-007	18 Sep 2026	Configuration management database	Data classification for the fraud analytics training corpus is incomplete, blocking its onboarding to the pilot	Data	One of three committed pilot workloads cannot proceed; benefit evidence delayed	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead	Approved	Open
ISS-008	25 Jun 2027	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	Chargeback rate card has not been agreed, so business units cannot budget for FY27 consumption	Governance	Migration commitments for Tranche 3 cannot be firmed up	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Approved with conditions	Open
ISS-009	28 May 2027	ALM tool — Helios ART board	Structural survey identified that four rack positions in hall B row 3 sit over a service void and cannot take 1,400 kg loading	Facilities	Configuration reduced by 32 GPUs unless the void is bridged	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Deferred to the next Board	Open
ISS-010	23 Apr 2027	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Image registry replication to the DR region is exceeding the four-hour RPO during peak build activity	Technical	DR objective in the service design not currently met	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Rejected	Open

8. Change register

Ref	Change requested	Raised by	Impact summary	Decision	Decided by	Date	Status
CR-001	Add coolant leak detection integration to the NOC	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	Parallel filesystem tier of 12 PB usable sustaining 1.2 TB/s to the compute estate	Approved	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	14 Jul 2026	Implemented
CR-002	Dual-source 20% of Tranche 2 accelerator volume	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	Signed container image supply chain with admission enforcement and firmware attestation	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	02 Aug 2026	In progress
CR-003	Bridge the hall B row 3 service void rather than relocate racks	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Self-service environment provisioning targeting a two-hour request-to-usable time	Approved	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	25 Aug 2026	Implemented
CR-004	Integration partner claim for additional structural works	Nexora Integration Services	Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1	Deferred	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	18 Aug 2026	Under review
CR-005	Defer confidential computing enabler from Tranche 2 to Tranche 3	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Consolidate all AI training workloads onto a shared 2,048-GPU platform in DXB-1 halls A and B	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	05 Sep 2026	Implemented
CR-006	Extend contractor SRE cover by six months	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	11 Sep 2026	Implemented
CR-007	Add a second CDU to hall A to reach the 60 kW design point	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	400G RoCEv2 leaf-spine fabric tuned for collective communication at 256-GPU job scale	Under review	—	09 Sep 2026	Open
CR-008	Reduce Tranche 2 GPU count from 2,048 to 1,792	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Signed container image supply chain with admission enforcement and firmware attestation	Rejected	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	01 Sep 2026	Closed

9. Change budget

Authority	Budget	Drawn to date	Remaining
<i>D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer</i>	<i>AED 91,200,000</i>	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>	<i>0</i>
<i>L. Haddad, CISO</i>	<i>AED 17,800,000</i>	<i>15 Oct 2026</i>	<i>3</i>
<i>E. Santos, Procurement Lead</i>	<i>AED 13,600,000</i>	<i>30 Nov 2026</i>	<i>1</i>
<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>	<i>AED 24,300,000</i>	<i>15 Dec 2026</i>	<i>2</i>

10. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
<i>Agile Release Train — all teams</i>	<i>Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract</i>
<i>Service Operations and FM provider</i>	<i>Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure</i>
<i>Business Owners and tenant representatives</i>	<i>Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026</i>
<i>CISO and Security Architect</i>	<i>Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4</i>